

Chicago Tribune



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BREAKING NEWS AT CHICAGOTRIBUNE.COM

Rubio reveals State Dept. overhaul

Plan to sharply cut staff, close, combine over 100 bureaus

By Farnoush Amiri and Matthew Lee
Associated Press

Secretary of State Marco Rubio unveiled an extensive overhaul of the State Department on Tuesday, with plans to reduce staff in the U.S. by 15% while closing and consolidating more than 100 bureaus worldwide as part of the Trump administration’s “America

First” mandate.

The reorganization plan, announced by Rubio on social media and detailed in documents obtained by The Associated Press, is the latest effort by the White House to reimagine U.S. foreign policy and scale back the size of the federal government. The restructuring was driven in part by the need to find a new home for the remaining functions of

the U.S. Agency for International Development, an agency that Trump administration officials and billionaire ally Elon Musk’s Department of Government Efficiency have dismantled.

“We cannot win the battle for the 21st century with bloated bureaucracy that stifles innovation and misallocates scarce resources,” Rubio said in a department-wide email obtained by AP. He said the

reorganization aimed to “meet the immense challenges of the 21st century and put America First.”

State Department spokeswoman Tammy Bruce echoed that sentiment, saying the “sweeping changes will empower our talented diplomats” but adding that it would not result in the immediate dismissal of personnel.

“It’s not something where people are being fired today,” Bruce told reporters Tuesday. “They’re



Secretary of State Marco Rubio, center, sits with President Donald Trump at an April 10 meeting.
ERIC LEE/THE NEW YORK TIMES

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‘LIFE IS FOREVER CHANGED’

By Rebecca Johnson and Evangeline Leventis
Chicago Tribune

When Carrie Mangoubi sends her young children off to school, she often worries about their safety. At least once a week, her deeply ingrained fear and uncertainty of shootings feels nearly inescapable, she said.

While these thoughts may not be “healthy,” Mangoubi said her “life is forever changed” after the 2022 Highland Park Independence Day parade mass shooting, which left seven people dead, four dozen injured and an entire community traumatized.

When the parade began, Mangoubi, her husband and their three kids took their seats farther down the route. Her first indication that something was awry happened when she saw band members frantically running. She watched as ambulances and fire trucks sped down the street with their lights and sirens blaring — the same emergency vehicles that had just passed her family minutes before with first responders waving and smiling. Someone in the crowd then shouted “there’s a shooter,”

Highland Park parade survivors hope sentencing brings relief, justice

Above: Carrie Mangoubi holds her daughter, Mia, 3, after her Magna Tiles tower was taken down in their home on Friday in Northbrook.
AUDREY RICHARDSON/CHICAGO TRIBUNE

Mangoubi said. She and her husband picked up their two youngest daughters and shielded their eldest daughter, who was 5 years old at the time, as she ran beside them. They sprinted to safety in their car.

“We didn’t see any blood, we didn’t hear any bullets, and so that’s why I say we are luckier than most that were there,” Mangoubi said. “But as a mother, having the responsibility to carry your infant away from an active shooter scene, that will never ever leave me.”

Last month, the gunman, Robert Crimo III, unexpectedly pleaded guilty to 21 counts of first-degree murder and 48 counts of attempted murder, minutes before opening statements were set to begin in his murder trial. His decision eliminated the need for a weekslong, high-profile court battle that would almost certainly have ended in a guilty verdict. His sentencing is scheduled to begin Wednesday morning in Lake County.

The 24-year-old, who fired an AR-15-style assault rifle from

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ANTONIO PEREZ/CHICAGO TRIBUNE

Earth Day cleanup efforts

Volunteers from People for Community Recovery and friends clean up along 130th Street near Indiana Avenue in honor of Earth Day and PCR’s founder Hazel Johnson on Tuesday. The first Earth Day was celebrated in 1970 to promote environmental protections.

Johnson to boost pressure on Springfield for funding

Local, national political landscape has shifted; Pritzker cool to visit

By Alice Yin and Jeremy Gerner
Chicago Tribune

Mayor Brandon Johnson will return to Springfield next week to ratchet up the pressure on his funding requests for Chicago, but under a local and national political landscape that has shifted starkly since his last excursion to the statehouse — and with Gov. JB Pritzker preemptively throwing cold water

on his visit.

At his Tuesday City Hall news conference, the mayor confirmed he will head to the Illinois General Assembly and meet with Pritzker as well as House Speaker Emanuel “Chris” Welch and Senate President Don Harmon. A flyer obtained by the Tribune shows the mayor’s political organization also plans to host a reception for the Chicago delegation at a Springfield venue next Tuesday evening.

The top of his agenda, Johnson told reporters, “hasn’t changed,” before his chief of staff Cristina

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TODAY’S WEATHER



High 76 Low 54

Complete Chicagoland forecast on Page 18

\$4.00 city and suburbs and elsewhere
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